



UNIVERSITY EXAMINATIONS: 2016/2017

**EXAMINATION FOR THE DEGREE OF BACHELOR OF SCIENCE IN
INFORMATION TECHNOLOGY**

BBIT 209 DECISION SUPPORT SYSTEMS

DISTANCE LEARNING

DATE: DECEMBER, 2016

TIME: 2 HOURS

INSTRUCTIONS: Answer **Question One** & ANY OTHER **TWO** questions.

QUESTION ONE [30 MARKS]

- a) Define a decision support systems. (2 Marks)
- b) List SIX characteristics of decision support systems. (6 Marks)
- c) Define a model as used in DSS. (2 Marks)
- d) Why is prototyping a desired method for the development of DSS. (4 Marks)
- e) Discuss Two limitations of expert systems. (2 Marks)
- f) Explain the Herbert Simon's decision making processes. (8 Marks)
- g) Name the THREE components of a decision support systems and explain the functions of each. (6 Marks)

QUESTION TWO [20 MARKS]

- a) Distinguish between structured, semi-structured and unstructured decisions (6 Marks)
- b) Compare and contrast MIS and DSS. (6 Marks)
- c) Describe the DSS framework by Power. Describe some key issues from this framework. (4 Marks)
- d) Distinguish between Expert systems and DSS. (4 Marks)

QUESTION THREE [20 MARKS]

- a) Demonstrate how a DSS can assist a manager in arriving as a decision. (6 Marks)
- b) Compare and contrast TPS and DSS. (6 Marks)
- c) Explain the goal seeking and what is scenarios as used in DSS. (4 Marks)
- d) State FOUR characteristics of Executive support systems. (4 Marks)

QUESTION FOUR [20 MARKS]

- a) Compare and contrast Executive support systems and DSS. (6 Marks)
- b) List EIGHT different types of DSS. (8 Marks)
- c) Explain the following approaches: (6 Marks)
 - (i) Heuristics
 - (ii) Satisficing
 - (iii) optimization

QUESTION FIVE [20 MARKS]

- a) Define a GDSS. (2 Marks)
- b) List FOUR characteristics of GDSS. (4 Marks)
- c) What are the FOUR advantages and FOUR disadvantages of GDSS. (8 Marks)
- d) Why is Ms Excel identified as a decisions support tool. (2 Marks)
- e) State FOUR capabilities of Executive support systems. (4 Marks)